DIPLOMA PROGRAMME PRACTICE / SL / SET A

Psychology / Paper 1

Question booklet · 90 minutes · 35 marks

Answer Questions 1–4 in Sections A and B. In Section C answer either Question 5 or Question 6. Use psychological knowledge and accurate terminology throughout.

Write your responses on separate answer paper. Use the marks beside each question to guide your time.

SECTION A

Knowledge and understanding

QUESTION 1 / 4 MARKS

Describe neuroplasticity, using one example to illustrate its role in behaviour.

QUESTION 2 / 4 MARKS

Explain how a schema can influence the recall of an event. Use one example.

SECTION B

Application to new situations

QUESTION 3 / 6 MARKS

Trainees learn the same unfamiliar folding sequence in six minutes. One display puts numbered instructions on a separate wall from the diagrams. Another places each instruction next to the matching fold. Both show the same words and pictures. Trainees using the second display usually make fewer sequencing errors on a new sheet.

Explain how cognitive load theory could account for this difference.

QUESTION 4 / 6 MARKS

At a depot most drivers privately favour moving a meeting. When the supervisor asks for a show of hands after three respected drivers publicly oppose the move, several supporters keep their hands down. In an anonymous vote later that day they support the move again. They had already understood both options.

Explain how conformity could account for the change between the public and anonymous responses.

SECTION C

Conceptual essays · choose one

QUESTION 5 / 15 MARKS

Discuss the concept of change with reference to stage theories and continuous models of cognitive development.

QUESTION 6 / 15 MARKS

Discuss the role of measurement in explaining reported differences in the prevalence of one mental health disorder between populations.